



City of Duluth

411 West First Street
Duluth, Minnesota 55802

Minutes

Library Board.

Tuesday, September 1, 2026

4:30 PM Evergreen Senior Center, 5830 Grand Ave. Duluth, MN

Call To Order

The meeting was called to order at 4:32 PM by Bill Arezzo, President

Welcome and Introductions

Present: Bill Arezzo, Lori Steinbach, Ellen Hatfield, Sue Henke, Sarah Kessler, Michelle Foshay

Also in attendance: Carla Powers, PPL Director Erik Birkeland, Library staff member Jason DeShaw

Absent: Carlee Bladl, Kati Annis, Jose Gonzalez

Review and Approve Agenda

Motion by Foshay, seconded by Henke, to approve agenda as drafted. Motion passed unanimously.

Approve Minutes of August 4 Meeting

Motion by Kessler, seconded by Foshay, to approve minutes. Motion passed unanimously.

Public Comment

None.

Reports

Library Manager's Report September 2026

Saturday hours at Main start after Labor Day.

Children's section at Main will be closed for the month of November while work is being done to upgrade the space. Project is funded by the Library Foundation. Grand reopening will most likely be early December.

Over 6,000 items were checked out via Port Cards (virtual library cards that every student in Duluth Public Schools and Harbor City International School has) during the 2025-26 school year.

Library Usage July 2026

Arrowhead Library System (ALS) Report September 2026

Executive Director Mollie Stanford has resigned and will wrap up her role on Jan. 29, 2027.

Friends of the Library Report

No meeting in August because of prepping for the annual book sale. Early estimate is that book sale raised about \$18,000.

Duluth Library Foundation Report

No meeting in August. Currently wrapping up fundraising for the children's section refresh.

Library Staff Report

Jason DeShaw shared that a new library catalog is coming. Library staff will have access to it in September, and it will be rolled out to patrons a few months later. DeShaw hopes to demo it for the Library Board this fall.

Old Business

Safety Updates

Slight uptick in incidents, nothing severe or out of the ordinary.

Main Library Facility/Regional Library Services District

**Birkeland and Powers are finalizing the work plan. Next step is to start writing an RFP for study.
City Council approved HUD grant agreement.**

Advocacy Update

No update.

2027 Library Budget

Expect status quo budget for 2027.

New Business

Library Manager Hiring Process

Birkeland reviewed the hiring process for the new Library Manager. Position has been posted and will close on Sept 20th. Goal is to have a couple rounds of interviews and to have the new person start in early December.

2027 Fee Schedule Recommendations

Board reviewed. Motion by Henke, seconded by Steinbach, to approve recommendations as drafted. Motion passed unanimously.

2027 Meeting Schedule

Board reviewed the meeting schedule for 2027. Will finalize in October.

Adjournment

Motion by Henke, seconded by Kessler, to adjourn the meeting. Motion passed unanimously. Meeting adjourned at 5:40 PM.

Next Meeting: October 6, 2026, Main Library Green Room